Colony Colour: Many bacteria develop colonies which are pigmented.(Table 5.3) Some bacteria produce and retain water insoluble pigments and the colonies appear coloured by taking the pigment intracellularly (Figure 5.14). But some bacteria produce water soluble pigment which diffuse into the surrounding agar. Example: Pyocyanin pigment of *Pseudomonas aeruginosa* is a water soluble pigment and give blue colour to the medium.



Figure 5.14: Pigmentation of bacterial colonies on culture medium



Certain water soluble pigments are fluorescent in nature Example: Py-overdin. Agar medium around the colonies glows white or blue green when exposed to ultraviolet light.

5.4.2 Nature of bacterial growth in liquid medium

1. If the entire broth appears milky and cloudy it is called turbid.
2. If deposit of cells are present at the bottom of the tube, the term sediment is used.
3. If the bacterial growth forms a continous or interrupted sheet over the broth it is called pellicle (Figure 5.15).

5.4.3 Growth and Colony Characteristics of Fungi

Fungi are eukaryotic organisms. They exist in both unicellular-yeast like form and in filamentous multicellular hyphae or mold form and some are dimorphic. Generally

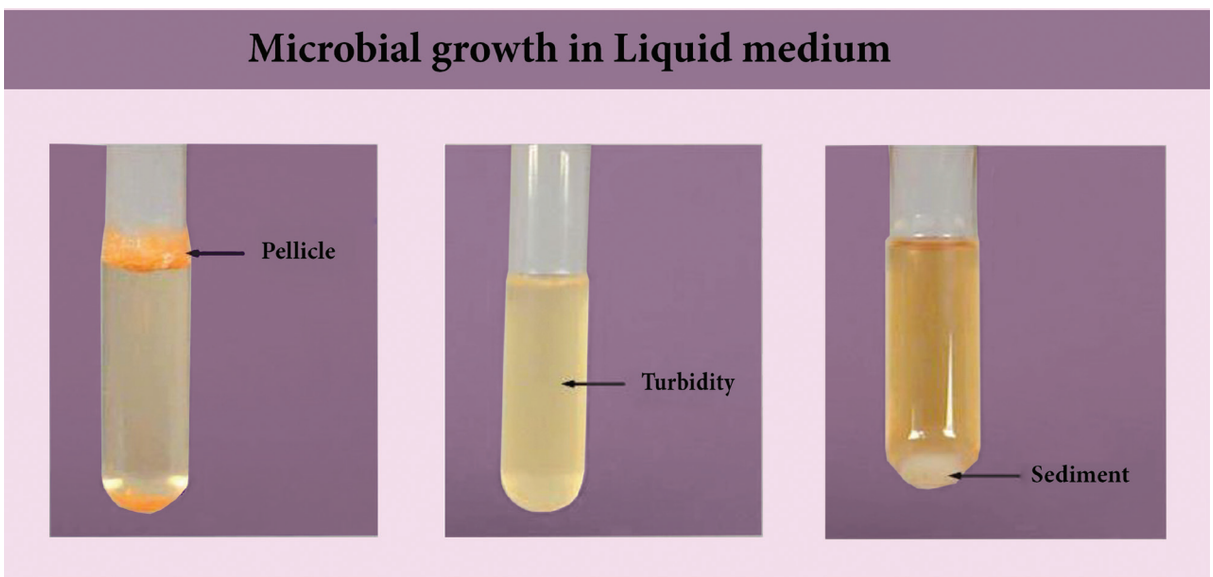


Figure 5.15: Microbial growth in Liquid medium

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